

SMM FOR BEGINNERS

(From scratch)

By Areesha Malik

A Note Before You Start

Please understand one thing before you begin:

These phases by Areesha Malik are not a paid course or a **professionally certified curriculum**. They are the exact learning journey I personally followed to learn Social Media Management and related skills **for free**, using accessible resources and putting what I learned into practice.

I'm sharing this roadmap so you don't have to spend months jumping from one random resource to another without knowing what to learn next.

But remember: ***a roadmap can show you the direction; you still have to walk.***

Whether you actually learn from these resources or stay in your comfort zone is ultimately your choice.

Why I Chose to Get Out of My Comfort Zone

I started this journey for reasons that were very personal to me:

- 1. I wanted to stop depending on my family for every expense.**
- 2. I know that the people who support me today won't always be able to do so.**
- 3. Financial independence matters.**

So, this journey is not just about learning Social Media Management.

It is about becoming capable.

You don't need to have money for an expensive course to start. You need **a direction, consistency, practice, and the willingness to learn.**

Now, the resources are in your hands.

What you do with them is up to you.

GOOD LUCK

WHAT YOU HAVE TO LEARN AND PRACTICE

PHASE 1 — SMM Foundations

Day 1: What is SMM + role of an SMM

Day 2: Platforms, metrics & algorithms

Day 3: Branding, positioning & target audience

Day 4: Audience & competitor research

PHASE 2 — Content Strategy

Day 5: Content strategy + content pillars+ content funnels

Day 6: Content ideation + research

Day 7: Copywriting — hooks, captions, CTAs

Day 8: Reels, carousels, stories & content calendars

PHASE 3 — AI FOR SMM

Day 9: AI as an SMM Assistant

Use AI for:

- Brainstorming content ideas
- Research assistance
- Creating content pillars
- Finding audience pain points
- Generating hook variations
- Caption drafts
- Reel scripts
- Repurposing content
- Creating content calendars
- Competitor-analysis assistance
- Summarizing analytics
- Creating client proposals/briefs

PHASE 4 — Client & Strategy

Day 11: Content calendar + scheduling

Day 12: Analytics & optimization

Day 13: Client management + getting started as an SMM

Day 14: Final client simulation/project.

PHASE 01

SMM FOUNDATIONS

Understand SMM

1. **Social Media:** Platforms where people and businesses communicate, share content, build communities, and market themselves.
2. **Social Media Management:** Managing a brand's social presence through content, strategy, engagement, scheduling, and analytics.
3. **SMM's Job:** Understand the business → understand the audience → create content → manage the account → analyse → improve.
4. **Social Media Strategy:** A plan that tells us what we're posting, who we're targeting, why we're posting it, and what result we want.
5. **Goal:** The specific result a business wants from social media — awareness, engagement, leads, sales, community, etc.
6. **Content Strategy:** Deciding what content to create, for whom, and what purpose each piece of content serves.

Platforms & Metrics

7. **Social Media Platforms:** Instagram, TikTok, LinkedIn, YouTube, Facebook, etc.; choose based on where the audience is and what the business needs.
8. **Content:** Anything a brand creates to communicate — Reels, carousels, Stories, photos, videos, lives, etc.
9. **Reach:** The number of unique people/accounts who saw your content.
10. **Impressions:** The total number of times your content was displayed, including multiple views from the same person.
11. **Engagement:** Actions people take on your content — likes, comments, saves, shares, replies, clicks, etc.
12. **Saves:** Usually show that someone found the content useful enough to keep for later.

13. **Shares:** Usually show that someone found the content valuable/relevant enough to send to someone else.
14. **Profile Visits:** People who became curious enough about your content to visit your profile.
15. **Followers:** People who chose to follow the account; important, but followers alone don't equal business success.

Brand, Positioning & Audience

16. **Brand:** The overall perception people have about a business — what they think and feel when they see it.
17. **Brand Identity:** The visual and verbal elements a business uses to present itself — colours, fonts, logo, visuals, messaging, etc.
18. **Brand Voice:** How the brand sounds when it communicates — professional, friendly, premium, educational, playful, etc.
19. **Positioning:** How you want your brand to be understood in the customer's mind compared with competitors.
20. **Target Audience:** The specific group of people you're creating content for based on factors like age, location, interests, needs, and problems.
21. **Pain Point:** A problem or frustration your audience is experiencing that your content/product can help solve.
22. **Customer Need:** What the audience actually wants or needs in order to solve their problem.

Research

23. **Audience Research:** Finding out what your audience wants, struggles with, asks, watches, buys, and cares about instead of simply guessing.
24. **Competitor Research:** Studying similar brands to understand their content, audience reactions, strengths, weaknesses, and opportunities.
25. **Content Gap:** A useful topic/problem your audience cares about that competitors aren't covering properly.
26. **Research Sources:** Instagram/TikTok comments, Reddit, reviews, competitor pages, Google searches, FAQs, and customer conversations.

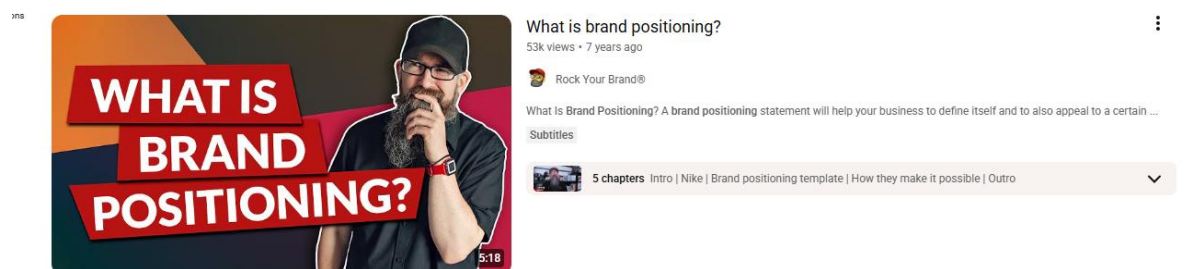
27. **Golden Rule:** Don't create content only because *you* think it's good — find evidence that your audience actually cares about it.

Ok so now, for phase 01- here are the links or Pictures.

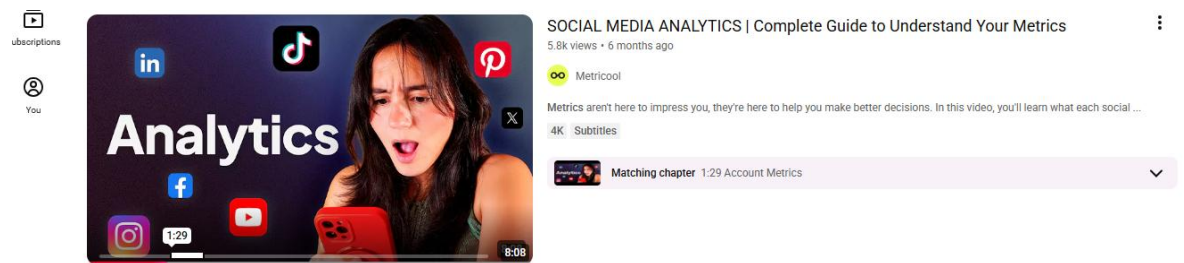
- [first step- take this course \(1.7 hour hardly\)](#)

(This is the course i took and it took me hardly 1.5 hour when i changed the speed. It's for the basics you can learn. Easy to understand)

- **For Branding and positioning**



- **For Metrics and analytics**



- **For competitor analysis / problem research**



Phase 01 Completed

These resources are your **starting point, not a limitation**. There are hundreds of other free resources online, so if you're still confused after watching these, **research and explore other explanations yourself**.

And remember: **your brain comes before AI**. Think, research, analyse, and solve problems yourself.

If you're not spending money on a course, you have to be willing to **invest your time in research**.

Don't become dependent on the roadmap. Learn how to find your own answers.

ASSIGNMENT 01

Now we stop learning and actually become an SMM.

- Your task: Create & Audit Your Own Personal Brand

Step 1 — Create your account

Choose your niche:

- SMM
- Marketing
- Graphic Design
- Copywriting
- Fitness
- Beauty
- Fashion
- accessories

- Any skill you're learning
- (In short see what your interests are. For example, i love handbags and jewellery so i want to work with brands like Astore pk, etc etc. Find your interests)

Step 2 — Account Checkup

Check:

Username: Is it simple and searchable?

Profile Picture: Is it clear/professional?

Bio: Does it explain who you help + what you offer?

Name Field: Does it contain your niche/keyword?

Link: Is there one if needed?

Highlights: Are they useful and organized?

Overall Profile: Can someone understand your page within 5 seconds?

Step 3 — Define Your Brand

Write:

Who am I?

What do I talk about?

Who am I helping?

What problem do I solve?

Why should someone follow me?

Step 4 — Define 3 Content Pillars (in this you can take help from AI. Claude, Gemini or ChatGPT by the good prompt)

For example:

Education → Teach what you know

Journey/BTS → Show what you're learning/doing

Value/Problem-solving → Solve your audience's problems

Step 5 — Start Posting

Create and publish your first 3 pieces of content.

Don't wait for a perfect feed, perfect logo, or 100 followers.

Final submission:

Profile screenshot + account audit + target audience + positioning + 3 content pillars + first 3 posts.

That's it.